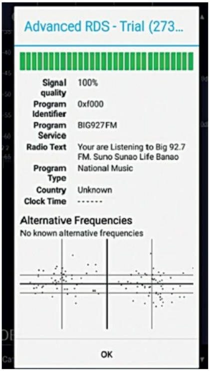

Fig. 12: RDS data values in SDRTouch

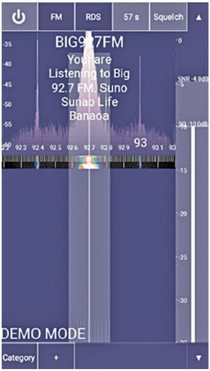

Fig. 13: Interface with RDS values in SDRTouch

Setup requirements

1. Android smartphone (preferably with Android 5 or higher version)
2. USB OTG adaptor
3. RTL-SDR dongle (DVB-T/DVB-T2)
4. Internet connection to download the apps
5. RTL-SDR driver (available in PlayStore, developed by Martin Marinov)
6. SDRTouch app (available in PlayStore, developed by Martin Marinov)

Hardware setup

1. First, connect the OTG adaptor carefully with the Android smartphone
2. Connect the antenna to the RTL-SDR dongle properly
3. Connect the USB dongle to the OTG adaptor
4. After connections are complete, place the device at a suitable location

Software setup

Download and install:

1. RTL-SDR driver from PlayStore
2. SDRTouch app from PlayStore. This app is available in two versions; testing was done using the free, limited-functionalities app
3. SDRoid app (free version) from PlayStore. It provides the spectrum function

The smartphone screen with all the above-mentioned software installed is shown in Fig. 4. The SDRTouch app interface is shown in Fig. 5.

Figs 6 through 13 show the app interface and basic options available in SDR apps for Android smartphones.

Notes. 1. The SDRTouch app (free version) supports spectrum viewing only for a limited time (few seconds).

2. Use a good-quality OTG adaptor/cable for the project.

3. SDRTouch supports audio recording.

4. Some mobile phones may not support the hardware and drivers. EFY

Madhuram Mishra is an ME (digital communication) student at NITTTR, Bhopal, with keen interest in circuit design and working with Arduino boards

Dr Sunil Mishra is a professor at Institute for Excellence in Higher Education (IEHE), Bhopal and also a fellow of IETE, India. His areas of interest are microwaves and antenna design